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To Whom It May Concern,

Most introductions in the development sector start with intent. Mine and Suveer's began with a spreadsheet, a carved wooden card holder, and a teenager explaining rural MSME onboarding rates like he'd been sitting in policy rooms for years.

When Suveer approached us, he had sent a detailed presentation mapping gaps in women-led MSME participation across underserved regions in North India. The presentation analyzed barriers in financial literacy, digital onboarding, and market access while proposing methods to identify untapped women-owned businesses through localized surveys and grassroots outreach. What caught my attention was the vision that Suveer carried along with a data backed proposal charting the potential of 85,000+ women-led businesses that Frontier Markets can tap into. To activate them in reality, he proposed a structured grassroots model that brings together local MSME partnerships, field surveys, trust-building at the community level, and the use of existing SHG and NGO networks to expand access and opportunity at scale.

Soon after, we invited him to our first meeting and Suveer came with a hand-carved wooden holder he had made himself, quietly putting it down on the table to organise the scattered visiting cards in the room before opening his laptop and saying, "Most rural businesses don't fail because women lack skill. They fail because the systems are never designed to listen to them long enough."

That sentence stayed with me.

Before approaching Frontier Markets, Suveer had already spent significant time working with women-led artisan groups and organizations through Neev Ventures and multiple NGO collaborations. His product ideas reflected the unusual blend of creativity and purpose that defines his personality: recycled tote bags stitched by women collectives, hand-poured Christmas candles inspired by local craft clusters, naturally dyed Holi colors packaged through sustainable micro-enterprise models. Even at his age, he viewed businesses not simply as income-generating mechanisms, but as ecosystems built around dignity, sustainability, and identity.

Over the course of our collaboration, Suveer worked closely with our outreach teams on financial literacy initiatives, entrepreneurship workshops, MSME activation, and rural business mapping. He helped identify underserved enterprise clusters, conducted market surveys, and contributed toward outreach impacting over **~18,000 rural women across 3 states**. His independent outreach and networks in northern India also strengthened Frontier Markets' visibility among local enterprise groups and women-led production communities.

Suveer was particularly fascinated by Frontier Markets' foundation scaling model, where rural women are not only beneficiaries, but also ecosystem builders, through its Meri Saheli platform. He was deeply involved in studying and contributing to outreach activities for the Super Saheli network, a gig worker opportunity model where trained women leaders onboard and support women-owned businesses in villages while also providing e-commerce assistance, market research surveys, digital training and implementation support for various corporate CSR initiatives. Suveer immediately saw the brilliance of

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this structure – the same network solving access gaps was also creating sustainable income opportunities for women at the grassroots level.

What distinguished Suveer was not only his analytical ability, but his way of working with people. During workshops, he had a remarkable ability to make women participate confidently rather than passively listen. His sessions combined bilingual explanations, visual demonstrations, and practical examples that simplified concepts like digital payments, pricing strategy, bookkeeping, and customer engagement.

Suveer always operated with the seriousness and ownership of an early-stage founder rather than a student volunteer, and yet in between intense discussions on digital commerce and financial access, he would casually perform astonishing card tricks for our team — somehow making a room full of exhausted professionals pause mid-meeting like children again. Oddly enough, that captures Suveer well: deeply analytical without ever becoming mechanical.

One moment especially stayed with me. During a workshop, a woman running a stitching unit referred to herself as someone "just helping at home." Suveer sat beside her after the session and helped calculate her actual monthly margins on a sheet of paper covered in rough pencil notes and chai stains. Ten minutes later, she laughed and said, "Then I'm not helping. I'm running a business." He smiled like that was the most normal revelation in the world.

Today, Frontier Markets along with Neev ventures has successfully mapped over 85,000 rural women businesses across 7 states in India that are ready to be onboarded, trained, and activated as part of our vision to digitize and elevate the incomes of 100k rural women businesses over the next 3 years. Suveer contributed meaningfully to this effort through field surveys, business mapping, grassroots outreach, and community-level engagement. More importantly, he deeply believed in the mission itself. He often spoke not about "impact numbers," but about building systems where women feel ownership over their work and futures.

Personally, I find his vision of helping empower and uplift over 100k rural women entrepreneurs in the coming years not idealistic, but entirely achievable. Because what makes Suveer extraordinary is not just his intelligence or initiative — it is that he combines ambition with humanity, structure with creativity, and seriousness with warmth. Very few young people leave behind both stronger systems and lighter rooms. Suveer somehow manages to do both.

Frontier Markets extends its strongest recommendation for Mr. Suveer Saigal. He is one of the most thoughtful and impactful young collaborators we have had the privilege to work with.

Warm regards,

Sushmita Ganguly

Head HR
Frontier Markets